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Developing an Interactive Survey Question Bank: Early Lessons Learned

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UK Data Archive
IASSIST 2010 – Session C1
June 2 2010

University of Essex JISC E·S·R·C ECONOMIC & SOCIAL RESEARCH COUNCIL

Promises, promises

"

… seek to maximise user involvement and feedback into the resources, creating "collaboratory" spaces based on Web 2.0 interactive technologies, to encourage users to access the real source of methodological expertise – each other. User expertise would be gathered in a variety of ways. There would be, as mentioned above, a "grey literature" repository where users could post and download working papers. In addition, there will be a discussion forum, where users can discuss issues raised, ask questions of one another, share information about upcoming events and work opportunities, etc.

"

Text from successful bid to ESRC.

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What do we mean by “interactive”?

- A typology of interaction:
  - Consumers
    - Passive: traditional; receivers; top-down delivery of information
    - Active: wants customised secure account/workspace
  - Contributors
    - Engaging: joins discussions; interacts with others; gregarious
    - Sharing: shares; uploads; tags; interacts with content; lone actor
  - Collaborators
    - As per Active Consumer but seeks secure account/workspace for collaboration with selected colleagues

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But, really, why do it?

- Harness external expertise/crowdsourcing
  - Contributors (Engaging and Sharing)
- Social networking/collaboration
  - Engaging Contributors; Collaborators
- Create evangelists
  - All types
- (Eventually) uncover emergent properties
  - All types

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What will success look like?

- User-generated content will be visible across the web site – sharing information will seem normal
- Critical mass of Contributors (Engaging and Sharing) helping/advising/tagging/even disagreeing
- Contributors will surprise us – in a good way!
- (In time) take up of individual/collaborative workspaces

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What we've done so far

- Initial focus on serving Passive Consumers via top-down communication using JISCMail and twitter
- Efforts to create opportunities for Engaging Contributors focused on Methodspace
- In all cases, we've used third party resources
  - Various problems outsourced (registration, potential loss of reputation) but lose come control (registration, resource failure)

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Summary

User type	User motivation	Tool used
Consumer (Passive)	Receive	JISCMail; twitter
Consumer (Active)	Customise	-
Contributor (Engaging)	Discuss	Methodspace
Contributor (Sharing)	Share	(Survey question search)
Collaborator	Collaborate	-

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Survey Question Bank - Windows Internet Explorer

http://www.surveynet.ac.uk/sqb/

Live Search

File

Favorites | Suggested Sites | Web Slice Gallery

Survey Question Bank

Page | Safety | Tools

SURVEY RESOURCES NETWORK

SURVEY QUESTION BANK

- About the SQB
- Question bank
- Surveys
- Topics
- Data collection zone
- Innovation zone
- Scales and instruments zone
- Harmonisation and classification zone
- International zone
- Learning and teaching zone
- Key contacts

SURVEY SKILLS

SURVEY QUESTION BANK

Welcome to the Survey Question Bank (SQB), co-ordinated by the UK Data Archive (UKDA) at the University of Essex.

There are currently two methods of searching for information:

- an interface that searches across the major UK and cross-national social survey questionnaires
- a Google search across the whole of the SRN web site

Users may also browse the SQB's holdings via:

- an A-Z list of major surveys
- an A-Z list of topics covered in those surveys

SURVEY QUESTION BANK

I want to locate ...

- questions
- questionnaires
- variables

Take me to ...

- SQB methods fact sheets
- SQB topic overviews

Get involved

SRN on JISCMail

SRN on Methodspace

SRN on twitter

News and events

Internet | 100%

start | 8 M. | iassist | Mic... | Sur... | Mic... | Sur... | Search Desktop | 14:50

Survey Question Bank - Question bank - Locate questions - Windows Internet Explorer
http://www.surveynet.ac.uk/sqb/qb/questions.asp
Live Search
File
Favorites
Suggested Sites
Web Slice Gallery
Survey Question Bank - Question bank - Locate questi...
Page
Safety
Tools

SURVEY QUESTION BANK

QUESTION BANK

I want to locate questions

Note: New search interface/functionality expected to go live in Summer 2010.

Make a suggestion. (Registration with methodspace.com required).

The SQB team is currently designing a search tool that will allow users to search across a subset of key, recent UK social surveys. It is expected that the results of this search will be question-level reports that allow the user to link to the relevant part of the questionnaire (PDF) and also to the frequency output of the variable that is derived from that question. The tool will utilise metadata stored in the ESDS Nesstar cataloque.

SURVEY RESOURCES NETWORK

SURVEY QUESTION BANK
About the SQB
Question bank
- **Locate questions**
- Locate questionnaires
- Locate variables
- Help
- Other question banks

Surveys
Topics
Data collection zone
Innovation zone
Scales and instruments zone
Harmonisation and classification zone
International zone
Learning and teaching zone

SURVEY QUESTION BANK

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SRN on twitter

News and events

Internet
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Sur...
Search Desktop
14:52

Survey Question Bank - Windows Internet Explorer
http://www.surveynet.ac.uk/sqb/surveys/bcs70.asp
Live Search
File
Favorites
Suggested Sites
Web Slice Gallery
Survey Question Bank
Page
Safety
Tools

1970 British Cohort Study

- Survey overview, associated resources (ESDS Longitudinal)

- **Survey documentation, including questionnaire(s)**
  - **2004-2005**
  - **1999-2000**
  - 1996 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1992 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1986 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1980 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1975 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1973 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1972 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation
  - 1970 - to be added in 2010, until then see ESDS documentation

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- Major survey on: Child development
- Dataset(s) available via the ESDS
- Publications using this survey: ESDS Longitudinal publications database | Centre for Longitudinal Studies bibliography
- View user comments (registration with methodspace.com required to add comments)

News and events

11 March 2010

New Surveys and Topics pages on the SQB site

A suite of pages on the major social surveys provides detail on over 50 surveys. In a first for the service, coverage extends to the key cross-national surveys.

In addition, a suite of pages on topics incorporates and extends

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Search Desktop
14:56

Survey Resources Network - Methodspace - home of the Research Methods community - Windows Internet Explorer
http://www.methodspace.com/group/surveyresourcesnetwork
Live Search
File
Favorites
Suggested Sites
Web Slice Gallery
Survey Resources Network - Methodspace - home of ...
Page
Safety
Tools

All Groups My Groups

+ Invite More People

Survey Resources Network

Created by Jack Kneeshaw

View Groups

Edit

See also Survey Research and Methodology Group.

Go to Survey Resources Network web site.

Discussion Forum

Edit

British Crime Survey 1 Reply
Please share anything BCS related: news, events, publications, jobs etc.
Started by Jack Kneeshaw. Last reply by John F Hall May 21.

Survey question search 1 Reply
We're working on a survey question database at www.surveynet.ac.uk/sqb/qb/questions.aspthat will allow users to find questions and then cross-reference themto the same/similar questions asked elsewhe...
Started by Jack Kneeshaw. Last reply by John F Hall May 21.

British Election Study
Please share anything BES related: news, events, publications, jobs etc.
Started by Jack Kneeshaw May 21.

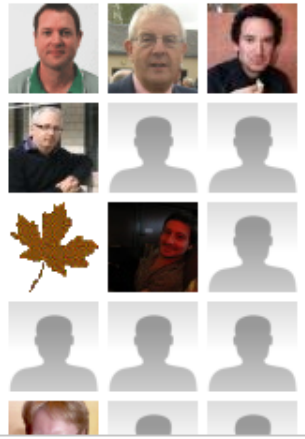
1970 British Cohort Study
Please share anything BCS70 related: news, events, publications, jobs etc.
Started by Jack Kneeshaw May 21.

Admin Options

Edit Group
Manage Group Members
Delete Group

Send Message to Group

Members (22)



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Sign Out
Inbox
Alerts
Connections – Invite
Settings
Quick Add...

SAGE ... Broug... to you... by SAGE: supporting researchers for more than forty years

Methodspace terms of use

What can you do on Methodspace today?

Read our featured book or journal article of the month
Share your latest research methods questions on the forums
Blog about your latest research methods activities
Look up events that are coming up in research methods

Methodspace – home of the Research Me... Chat | 8 Online
Done
Internet
100%
start
8 M.
iassist
Mic...
Sur...
Mic...
Sur...
Search Desktop
14:54

State of play, raw data

SURVEY RESOURCES NETWORK QUESTION BANK visitors - 28,209

JISCM@il sign-ups - 84

twitter sign-ups - 41

Methodspace sign-ups - 22

Contributors to JISCMail/twitter/Methodspace - 6

consume

contribute

"i-RATIO" - 4701 : 1 (or 0.02%)

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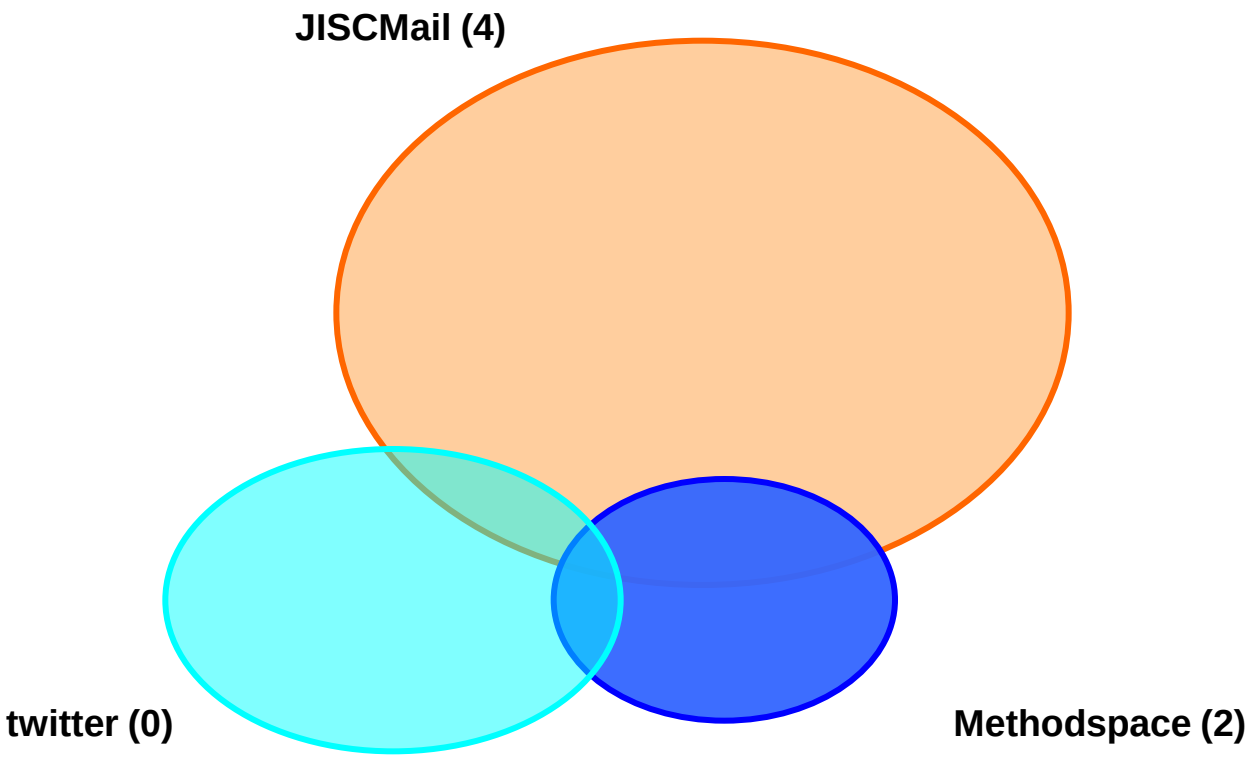
State of play, Venn



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“We built it; they didn’t come (yet)!”

- Why not?:
  - Failure of service to make contribution attractive and easy
    - Nowhere near the goal of making information sharing the norm
    - Low visibility
  - Academics traditionally reluctant to share?
    - Possible but unlikely given other evidence, e.g., case studies/fact sheets etc. provided
  - Other barriers:
    - Third party resources one step removed from SQB?
    - Related to above: no SQB membership = no community?

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Lessons learned

- Treat building an interactive service like establishing a garden
  - Need to seed, fertilise and then nurture until established
- Strength in numbers?
  - Hope to team up with related data services so that Methodspace area has multiple entry points and visible to more users
- Limit reliance on third party resources
  - Allow users to interact with content on SQB web pages

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Forthcoming: Survey Question Search

- Searchable archive of survey questions
  - Best features of some of those listed @ surveynet.ac.uk/sqb/qb/otherquestionbanks.asp
- In-house programming, customisation of database sitting behind ESDS Nesstar catalogue
- Push to enable Sharing Contributors > real effort to harness wisdom of crowd
  - Comments/tags
  - “See also” connections/associations – emergent properties?
  - Suggest new content

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Search - Windows Internet Explorer
http://www.surveynet.ac.uk:8080/index/search.aspx?collectionid=1099
Live Search
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Web Slice Gallery
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SURVEY QUESTION BANK

QUESTION BANK

Submit a survey question

Search questions for:

Question text	

Refine the search:

Survey title	drop-down list			
Country	drop-down list			
Year	From:	drop-down list	To:	drop-down list

<Reset> Search tips <Search>

Results 1-2 of 2

When people are facing difficulties in their lives, sometimes they use 'self-help' of various kinds to find ways of dealing with those issues. In the last year have you done any of the things on this card? **| British Social Attitudes Survey, 2007 |** Access full detail

Which, if any, of the alternative or complementary therapies shown on this card have you used? Just tell me the numbers **| British Social Attitudes Survey, 2007 |** Access full detail

Question text: When people are facing difficulties in their lives, sometimes they use 'self-help' of various kinds to find ways of dealing with those issues. In the last year have you done any of the things on this card?

Survey title: British Social Attitudes Survey, 2007

Country: Great Britain

Valid responses: 2102

Invalid responses: 2022

Response value	Response value label	Response frequency
0	Not mentioned	1758
1	Mentioned	316
9	Don't know	10
10	Not answered	18
-2	Skip, versions A+B	2022

Interviewer instructions: CARD L17 CODE ALL THAT APPLY Multicoded (Maximum of 5 codes)

Question applicable to: VERSIONS A+B: ASK ALL

Universe sampled: Location of units of observation: National Population: Adults (18 and over) living in private households in Great Britain (excluding the 'crofting counties' north of the Caledonian Canal).

Sampling: Multi-stage stratified random sample Sampling is conducted in four stages; from 1993 the sample has been drawn from the Postcode Address File, whereas in previous years it was drawn from the Electoral Register.

Study type: Repeated cross-sectional study. The BSA survey is conducted annually.

View user comments (3)

View the same/similar questions in this survey series

View the same/similar questions in other surveys

Comment on this question

Submit a survey question

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Issues to consider

- How to contribute?
  - Freetext
  - Http links
  - Radio buttons
- Identifying what is/isn't user-generated content
  - Risk to reputation
- Legal
  - Copyright/defamation
- Moderation
  - Checks prior to publication
  - Mechanisms for challenging/correcting content
  - Resources required
- Registration or anonymous posting?

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Finally: For next year …

- “Grey” literature repository
  - Though may not be required if users can add http links to content in the Survey Question Search (avoids responsibility of hosting)

- Customised workspace for Active Consumers and Collaborators

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surveynet.ac.uk/sqb

methodspace.com/group/surveyresourcesnetwork

twitter.com/surveynetacuk

info@surveynet.ac.uk

kneejw@essex.ac.uk

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